

For Want of a Nail!

Sunday, December 28th, 2003

AM Service - Sermon Book 7

Δ denotes prologue slide

Σ denotes drama, audio or video cue

Isaiah 22:23,24a KJV

Email Humor: "Mid East Mystery?"

"Everyone seems to be wondering why Muslim terrorists are so quick to commit suicide."

Let's see now:

No Jesus, No Wal-Mart, No television, No baseball, No football, No basketball, No hockey, No golf, No Home Depot, No pork BBQ, No hot dogs, No burgers, No lobster, No shellfish, No gumbo, No jambalaya.

More than one wife.

Rags for clothes and towels for hats. Constant wailing from the guy next-door because he's sick and there are No doctors. Constant wailing from the guy in the tower. No chocolate chip cookies. No Christmas. No Disney World, You can't shave. Your wives can't shave. You can't shower to wash off the smell of donkey cooked over burning camel dung.

The women have to wear baggy dresses and veils at all times. Your bride is picked by someone else. She smells just like your donkey, but your donkey has a better disposition.

Then they tell you that when you die it all gets better!

I mean, really, IS THERE A MYSTERY HERE ??

Isaiah 22:23,24a KJV

“And I will fasten Him as a nail in a sure place; and he shall be for a glorious throne to His father’s house. 24. And they shall hang upon Him all the glory of His father’s house...”

- How many times have you started a project and it couldn’t be completed because of something small... Something missing...
- Maybe wanting to bake something and you had one missing ingredient...
- How many lives have been started and they never realized there was one missing part...

Sadly - and they never understood the mystery of what it was they were missing...

In William J. Bennett’s book, The Book of Virtues there is a story of how England’s King Richard III lost his kingdom in the late 15th century.

King Richard III had sent his groom to the blacksmith to ready a horse for battle; however, the blacksmith had no more iron after supplying the king’s whole army for the last few days. Fortunately, the blacksmith found a bar of iron enough to make four horseshoes but, unfortunately, after nailing on three shoes, he was short.

When the blacksmith informed the groom that he was short one or two more nails, the groom exclaimed, “I told you I can’t wait. I hear the trumpets now. Can’t you just use what you’ve got?” The blacksmith repeatedly warned the groom that the last shoe was not as dependable as the others. Nevertheless, the groom urged the blacksmith to hurry and finish the job or suffer the king’s wrath.

As the battle raged on, one of the horseshoes fell off the horse of king Richard as he was riding to his soldier’s aid. Of course, the frightened animal fell, and then ran away.

When all was almost lost, the frantic king waved his sword in the air and shouted his known last words: "A horse! A horse! My kingdom for a horse!"

The battle inspired a famous saying:

**"For want of a nail, a shoe was lost,
For want of a shoe, a horse was lost,
For want of a horse, a battle was lost,
For want of a battle, a kingdom was lost,
And all for the want of horseshoe nail!"**

All for the want of a NAIL!

Something so small...

First of all – this morning...

I want to share with you that no one is insignificant...

1. Δ Everyone is a nail!

(Pass Out Nails!)

This year – has been great... Throughout the halls of our church you can see beautiful pictures of outreaches... (All hanging on nails) On the other hand... we have still be transitioning and God has added many new families... We are so thrilled to have...

This new year of 2004 I want to see marked as a year to **Δ "GO BEYOND!"** Whatever we have done before to do more... "Whatever it takes... GO BEYOND!" Let's do it! Let's join together and make every Sunday in 2004 greater than the one before... Let's determine everyday

of the week to be greater than the previous... How many of you would say, "Pastor, you can count on me!"

To reach that goal... I want you to know how important you are... each and everyone of you... I want to share with all of you... today... You are important!

Tell the person next to you – [Δ "You are important!"](#)

Everyone is a nail!

• **God has called all of us to build the kingdom...**

Sunday School teachers, Bus Drivers, Royal Rangers Leader, Missionettes, Deacon, Greeters, Hospitality, Ushers, Altar Workers, Choir, Parking Lot Ministry, Youth Ministry, Children's Church,

• **You are the stuff that holds things together...**

• **You are the glue... You are the nails that hold things together...**

You can't be indifferent...

What is indifference? To be indifferent is to feel nothing, to represent nothing, and to value nothing.

In England, a graffiti question scrawled on a walled asked: "What is apathy?" On its side was an answer: "Who cares?"

Question:

• **What do nails do?**

- Fasten things
- Keep things from making noise
- Join things together (two boards!)
- Nails have to be driven... You have to be driven to be a nail!

- Hang things on them... Hold that! (Confidence)
- Nails are made of steel... Forged
- Nails are sharp...

Matthew 16:17-19

“And Jesus answered and said unto him, “Blessed art thou, Simon Bar-jona: for flesh and blood hath not revealed it unto thee, but my Father which is in heaven. 18. And I say also unto thee, that thou art Peter, and upon this rock I will build my church; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it. 19. And I will give unto thee the keys of the kingdom of heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt bind on earth shall be bound in heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven.”

Jesus was telling Simon Peter you are a nail in a sure place... A Rock!

- **There are people in my life that I lean on...**
 - People I pray with...
 - People I confide in...
 - People who are nails... They may not tell me always what I want to hear... But I can count on them... I can confide in them... I can trust they will be there...
- **There are people you need to lean on...**
- **WE need a church full of leaders...**
- **Ever heard the saying... Δ “Tough as Nails!” That’s what Jesus was telling Simon... You are a Rock!**
 - Simon Fasten things (Lock and unlock)
 - Simon Keep things from making noise
 - Simon you will hold things together (two boards!)
 - Nails have to be driven... You have to be driven to be a nail!

- Simon we will Hang things on you... Hold that!
- Simon Peter you will be forged as steel...
- Simon Peter you will be sharp...
- We want to know we can count on you Simon Peter

19. "And I will give unto thee the keys of the kingdom of heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt bind on earth shall be bound in heaven: and whatsoever thou shalt loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven."

- **There will be things you will bind**
- **There will be things you will loose**
- **And it shall be done!**

Sickness... Bind it!

Disease... Bind it!

Cancer... Bind it!

Divorce... Bind it!

- **There are things to loose...**

Blessings... Loose them!

Healing... Be loosed!

Salvation for unsaved loved ones... Be Done!

2. Δ He is a nail in a sure place

Psalms 127.1 KJV

"Except the Lord build the house, they labor in vain that build it: except the Lord keep the city, the watchman waketh but in vain."

Δ "Except the Lord..."

- **I can't build this ministry on my own strength...**
- **I can't – bind or loose on my own power...**

• **The Lord has to build the house...**

Acts 4:33 KJV

“And with great power gave the apostles witness of the resurrection of the Lord Jesus: and great grace was upon them all.”

It's His grace... His power... I can't do it alone... His Spirit... His authority... But it has been given unto us...

Acts 19:11,12 KJV

“And God wrought special miracles by the hands of Paul: 12. So that from his body were brought unto the sick handkerchiefs or aprons, and the diseases departed from them, and the evil spirits went out of them.”

Δ “He is the nail in a sure place!”

- You can count on Him... Say it! You can count on Him!
- To the disciples on the sea of Galilee – He was a nail in sure place...
- To David on the field of battle – He was a nail in a sure place...
- To Daniel in the den of lions – He was a nail in a sure place...
- To Paul and Silas at midnight – He was nail in a sure place...
- To John being boiled in oil – He was a nail in a sure place...
- To Joseph in the prison – He was a nail in a sure place...
- To Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego – He was a nail in a sure place...
- To Children of Israel needing a deliverer – He was a nail in sure place...
- Moses crossing the Red Sea – He was a nail in a sure place...
- To Samson pushing against the columns of the Philistine temple – He was nail in sure place
- In the garden of Gethsemane – He was a nail in a sure place...
- In the court of Herod - In Pilate's judgment hall – He was a nail in sure place...
- At Calvary's – He was a nail in sure place...
- He offers His hands... for nails to be driven through...

- He offers His feet... for nails to pierce...
- He offers His brow... for a crown of thorns...
- He offers His side... for a soldier's spear...
- All for my salvation... He is worthy to be counted on...

3. Hang upon Him all the glory!

Isaiah 22:23,24a KJV

"And I will fasten Him as a nail in a sure place; and he shall be for a glorious throne to His father's house. 24. And they shall hang upon Him all the glory of His father's house..."

ILLUSTRATION... A. W. Tozer, Christian Publications, 1964, p. 90

"Worship is to feel in your heart and express in some appropriate manner a humbling but delightful sense of admiring awe and astonished wonder and overpowering love in the presence of that most ancient Mystery, that Majesty which philosophers call the First Cause, but which we call Our Father Which Are in Heaven."

Vs. 24. "And they shall hang upon Him all the glory of His father's house..."

This word – "HANG" – Has such a varied meaning...

1. *transitive and intransitive verb* **suspend**: "to suspend or fasten something so that it is held up from above and not supported from below."

Truly that is what we do today... We Hang upon Him all the glory of His Father's house. We give Him the glory...

Revelation 19:1-4 NLT

¹ "After this, I heard the sound of a vast crowd in heaven shouting, "Hallelujah! Salvation is from our God. Glory and power belong to him alone."

I love that song: "To God be the Glory!"

"How can I say thanks,
for all the things you have done for me...
Things undeserved, yet you came to
Prove your love to me...
The voices of million angels
Cannot express my gratitude...
All that I am and ever hope to be...
I owe it all to thee...
To God be the glory... To God be the glory...
To God be the glory... for the things HE has done...
With His blood He has saved me...
With His power He has raised me...
To God be the glory... for the things He has done!"

But the New Living Translation brings a deeper light to this scripture...

Isaiah 22:24 New Living Translation

"He will be loaded down with responsibility, and he will bring honor to even the lowliest members of his family."

John 12:20-26 NLT

²⁰ "Some Greeks who had come to Jerusalem to attend the Passover ²¹ paid a visit to Philip, who was from Bethsaida in Galilee. They said, "Sir, we want to meet Jesus." ²² Philip told Andrew about it, and they went together to ask Jesus. ²³ **Jesus replied, "The time has come for the Son of Man to enter into his glory."** ²⁴ The truth is, a kernel of wheat must be planted in the soil. Unless it dies it will be alone – a single seed. But its death will produce many new kernels – a plentiful harvest of new lives. ²⁵ Those who love their life in this world will lose it. Those who despise their life in this world will keep it for eternal life. ²⁶ All those who want to be my disciples

must come and follow me, because my servants must be where I am. And if they follow me, the Father will honor them."

What responsibility...

What dedication...

What passion... our Savior has for us...

This responsibility and Glory He will share...

Those that are... "A Nail in a Sure Place!"

**"For want of a nail, a shoe was lost,
For want of a shoe, a horse was lost,
For want of a horse, a battle was lost,
For want of a battle, a kingdom was lost,
And all for the want of horseshoe nail!"**

**All for the want of a NAIL!
Something so small...**

**You're not insignificant...
Neither is your God...**